

POVERTY AND INEQUALITY ANALYSIS

Question	To what extent are the poor responsible for their plight? (Topic/s) Poverty and Inequality
Stand	For most cases , the poor are not responsible for their plight because they may be in that situation due to external factors they cannot control , although in some circumstances people are stuck in poverty because of their individual actions and attitude.
TS 1	The poor is not responsible for the situation that they are in because of the unfavourable environment that they live in which impedes them from even making efforts to escape the realm of poverty. 2 sub points - 1. war torn countries → resources diverted to maintain military instead of tackling poverty → damages are done to infrastructure, disruption to economic activities, prevent inflow of FDI → fertile land may be destroyed → people lose their lives and become homeless → it worsens poverty as well because they may be countries that has been slapped with sanctions which makes it more challenging for them to even receive basic necessities that the countries may receive through trade. Example:- Comparison between two African states where until 1990 Burundi and Burkina Faso had similar rates of growth and income levels. But in late 1993, civil war erupted in Burundi after the assassination of the president where 300000, mostly civilians died within a decade and now peaceful state Burkina Faso is one-and-a-half times richer. 2. Some individuals also live in countries whereby they are limited by the geographical endowments which impedes on their economic development. For example they may be landlocked or far away from the coasts which leads to drastically reduced access to maritime trade or being continuously exposed to natural calamities and weather conditions which lead to the destruction of infrastructure and crops respectively preventing economic growth. Example:- In 2017, Puerto Rico had been hit by Hurricane Maria and the poorest communities were impacted the worst whereby even after two years they were still recovering using aid that they had to wait for for months as compared to their richer counterparts who has already had their houses rebuilt and were up and moving. AR:- They should not be held accountable because all of these factors and reasons are out of their control and they do not choose to be in such situations. Most of the time such situations further aggravate the problems of

	poverty pushing individuals deeper below the poverty line even if there are efforts made to reverse the issue.
TS 2	Some argue that the poor are living in poverty because its a reflection of their own choices and habits and their lack of hardwork. Many believe that people are still stuck in poverty simply because they are lazy and do not put in the work to get out of the situation that they are stuck in. There is a widespread belief that if one work hard, stay in school, get married, do not have children before they can afford them, they would not be this poor. Example:- In countries like Singapore, individual responsibility is being emphasized where self reliance is highly valorised as a trait where Singaporeans should strive to maintain. It is defined around continuous employment and lifelong savings; self-reliance is about accumulating money from employment to pay for housing, healthcare, and education. Self-reliance is about not relying on the state or on society for these needs. This is highly reflected in policies such Central Provident Fund where people are encouraged to save up to sustain and fund themselves during their future retired years. Therefore, it has become a culture for people to harbour these beliefs that poor people simply lack the hardwork and effort to get out of the circumstance they are in.
TS 3	Nevertheless, this argument is highly problematic because the reason why the individuals are stuck in this vicious cycle of poverty is because of a deeper systemic issue which substantiates for the lack of societal support. Such beliefs above occur due to a psychological concept called fundamental attribution error whereby people have the natural tendency to see the behaviour of others as determined by their character while excusing their own behaviour on circumstances. → evident in how US Housing Secretary Ben Carson called poverty “a state of mind”. However in reality, such notions of victim blaming poor people in the first place is the reason why there is a lack of effort in solidifying policies to help the poor to break out of the poverty cycle in the first place. Example:- There was a national poll conducted by National Public Radio (NPR), the Kaiser Family Foundation, and Harvard University’s Kennedy School on nearly 2,000 Americans 18 or older, where 52% of Americans belive that lack of motivation was a big reason why people are in poverty. This shows that such beliefs are widely held as part of the American culture as well had led to United States cutting spending on health insurance and safety nets that protect the poor and marginalised people under President Trump’s presidency.

	These perspectives and stereotypes of poor people for hinder the prospects of better conversations about how solutions can be made effective to directly tackle the root cause of poverty rather than seeing money spent on lower income people as a waste of taxpayer dollars. As such ineffective policies or policies that can help them get access to basic necessities are scraped which leads to an absence of a proper societal assistance kept in place for the poor to be able to rely on with which they can break out of the poverty cycle in the first place.
TS 4	The poor are not responsible for their plight that they are in because IN MANY CASES they are in the hands of external parties that in the pursuit of their own self-interests disguised as acts of “selflessness” in some cases has worsened their plight. Example:- The US gave foreign aid to afghanistan in terms of military support to fulfil their objectives of dismantling the Talibans so as to avenge for the lives lost in 9/11 as well as to rebuild the country and pull people out of poverty. Unfortunately the money fell into the hands of a corrupt government and the money was stolen and what was left was only spent in cities and not rural areas, causing people to still be trapped in poverty. To make matters worse, this aid was drastically counterproductive because the military aid to track down the Taliban and al Quaeda leaders by funding the mujahadeen leaders in exchange had created cruel warlords that utilised military techniques taught by the US to kill civilians which worsened the violence in the country, further aggravating the issue of poverty. Lack access to basic rights like education and a safe space to set up business and stuff like that → had worsened poverty in such places → just to fulfil the objectives of a country with higher power and immense wealth.

POLITICS AND GOVERNANCE

Freedom is the power or right to act, speak, or think as one wants without hindrance or restraint, and the absence of a despotic government.²⁷

Question	How far does the state have the right to restrict the freedom of the individual? (Bijal)
Stand	The state has the right to restrict the freedom of people, but if done too much could override the fundamental right of liberty that individuals have.
TS 1	It is fair for the state to restrict the freedom of people in terms of the freedom to act in order to ensure public security and welfare → Covid-19 mask-wearing in order to prevent the spread of the virus in US → Crimes which endangers people obviously → drugs in Singapore (give different examples of crimes for illustrative range) Need to explain how the benefits of causing inconvenience in restricting ones freedom outweighs the consequence that may result if not done in the first place
TS 2	However, an abuse of this power to be able to restrict on the liberty that people have can infringe on their right to freedom of information and doing so may be counterproductive and result in undesirable consequences. https://www.coe.int/en/web/freedom-expression/freedom-of-expression-and-information-in-times-of-crisis(very well written) (apparently the document states how government censorship affects the checks and balances that take place between the government and its people and the media to make sure that there is no abuse of power from the government's side and that citizens have the right to criticise and scrutinise the actions of the government to ensure that there is trust and communication between members of the community and the state to prevent further mass hysteria and catastrophic consequences) → example of the whistleblowing doctor in China → Dr Li in China had warned medics of the disease that looked like SARS but he was told by the police to stop spreading false rumours and this censorship caused the government to severely downplay the virus and exacerbated the spread. This caused major distrust and anger towards the government. SG trace-together saga
TS 3	Nevertheless, it is fair for the state to restrict the freedom that people have in terms of receiving information to a certain extent to protect confidential information as well as prohibited information to ensure the well-being of the state, (need to refer to the characteristic of social media providing easy access to information that may cause self radicalisation also for the fact that social media allows information to spread like wildfire which if such information is not censored or destroyed in its origin may extend and hurt a larger population at a fast rate)

	→ Extremist values that one learns from online and due to unlimited information about it and become indoctrinated (arrest those who have been radicalised and there is an authority that handles that) → censorship of public health information (the leaked singpass passwords in singapore or something) and illegal explicit videos that incriminate and put young people in harm's way (child pornography)
TS 4	It is fair for the state to restrict the freedom of people in terms of the freedom of expression to prevent societal divisions and disorders by preventing hate speech and false speech There is a growing necessity to combat hate speech because if gone unchecked, people will be illusioned to think that they can abuse their right freedom of expression without any repercussions. This may lead to the proliferation of hate speech and false speech which leads to not only the discrimination of targeted individuals, but with the advent of technology it may lead to harming of society as a whole. With the protection of such a right, when it goes unregulated, it may lead to a widespread violation of a myriad of human rights and social tension and fragmentation. With such detrimental and long lasting irreversible negative impacts of uncontrolled free speech, the government has an autonomy to restrict this right for those who abuse it in order to achieve the greater good for society. → Talk about the impact of hate speech both on social media and in real life E.g. Poly professor who picked on interracial couple E.g. racist comments left by people online → Talk about the need to censor fake news that can damage peoples reputation or affect society as a whole E.g. the POFMA law E.g people or companies whose reputation has been destroyed due to fake speech

Question	'In a free society, there should be no restrictions on the freedom of speech.' Discuss. Free society is one where people are free to live their lives as they wish without infringing upon other peoples rights A free society is a spontaneous society. It builds up from the actions of individuals, following the rules that promote peaceful cooperation. It is not imposed from above by political authorities. Government has a very limited role in a free society. No restrictions → people be allowed/permitted Freedom of speech → the power or right to express one's opinions without censorship, restraint, or legal penalty.
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Stand	Free speech should be limited to a certain extent as the unregulated freedom to speak may lead to grave consequences, but too many restrictions on free speech could badly override the basic rights of humans to express their opinions freely.
TS 1	There is a need to restrict the freedom of people in terms of the freedom of speech to prevent societal divisions and disorders. Increased globalised world → every society is pluralistic with ppl of many different races and background → common for people to not agree with each others ideals , traditions and beliefs There is a growing necessity to combat hate speech because if gone unchecked, people will be illusioned to think that they can abuse their right freedom of expression without any repercussions. This may lead to the normalisation of disrespecting each others beliefs which leads to not only the discrimination of targeted individuals, but with the advent of technology it may lead to harming of society as a whole. With the protection of such a right, when it goes unregulated, it may lead to a widespread violation of a myriad of human rights and social tension and fragmentation. This may escalate to violence. With such detrimental and long lasting irreversible negative impacts of uncontrolled free speech, the government has an autonomy to restrict this right for those who abuse it in order to achieve the greater good for society. Example:- In france, there is a freedom to blaspheme which means that citizens are allowed to freely criticize religion, politicians or believe in whatever they want → Charlie Hebdo → a satirical magazine which mocks religions like Christianity, Judaisim and Islam where they drew highly offensive drawings of the Prophet Muhammad which incited the Charlie Hebdo attacks by people who were avenging the Prophet Muhammad → even after this the Charlie Hebdo magazines continued which really divided people on whether this should be allowed, and because of such magazines citizens still live in threat. In contrast, Singapore has an interventionist approach by clamping down on offensive comments where one of the many examples is how in 2022, Singapore PR Sun Sicong was sentenced to 18 months' probation for making offensive comments about Muslims. This has allowed SG to enjoy racial and religious peace and harmony. In this case in SG, people face less threat than in France in the holistic sense due to the sensible restrictions in speech which would allow for more social harmony and cohesion which would allow individuals to live without the fear for their safety. This would allow them to experience more liberation in terms of expression of faith that is core to their identity.
TS 2	However, too many restrictions on the freedom of speech may allow states to abuse their powers to get members of the society to restrict voices of dissent

to impose their ideals and mask certain issues from society's point of view
→ blinds people to recognise the issues in society and even if they do they are unable to voice them out which further causes them to be trapped under an unfair governance. → even if they do want to make a stand they would doing so at a potential risk for their lives → society moves back → it would also thus be a gross violation of their human rights (article 25 where everyone has a right to a standard of living adequate for the health and well being of themselves)

Example:- Use of the "Big Lie." In North Korea, all "news" is positive. According to the country's rigidly controlled media, North Korea has never suffered famine or poverty, and citizens would willingly sacrifice themselves for their leader. The official Korean Central News Agency said that leader Kim Jong Il is so beloved that after a deadly munitions train explosion in a populated area, people ran into buildings to save the ubiquitous portraits of the "Dear Leader" before they rescued their own family members.

In Turkmenistan too

<https://www.chathamhouse.org/2021/06/freedom-expression-under-threat-southeast-asia>

All of the countries of Southeast Asia currently sit in the bottom half of the [World Press Freedom Index](#), with four – Brunei, Laos, Singapore and Vietnam – ranked below 150 in the 180-country list, and Myanmar expected to join them following its February 2020 coup.

Singapore and Malaysia

Laws dating to the colonial period criminalize acts with a 'seditious tendency' or those likely to 'excite disaffection against' the government.

- Malaysia → 1988 Communications and Multimedia Act → bans the 'improper use' of network facilities while

	● Singapore ○ → 2019 Protection from Online Falsehoods and Manipulation Act → empowers ministers to order websites to delete articles without a court order. Importantly, the vague language of 'seditious' and 'improper' in these cases allow prosecutors to define them at will. ○ 2021 → Foreign interference Law https://www.theguardian.com/world/2021/oct/11/singapores-new-foreign-interference-law-leaves-journalists-like-me-with-an-impossible-puzzle
Indonesia	Electronic Information and Transactions (ITE) Law bans online comments that 'violate decency...insult or defame, spread false news...[or] cause hatred'
Thailand	authorities use laws of <i>lèse-majesté</i> to criminalize the 'defamation or insult' of the king
Philippines	Criminal Code outlaws libel but without providing a definition of the crime while the directors of two news websites in Cambodia, TVFB and Rithysen, were jailed in 2020 after their reporting was deemed 'incitement to cause chaos and harm social security'.
Most of the restriction of freedom of speech in SEA seems to be targetted to reduce political dissent ● Politically-motivated prosecutions of media outlets have been a particular problem in both the Philippines and Cambodia. In 2017, the English-language, Cambodia Daily was forced to close by the government's tax authorities following a sudden inspection after the publication of a number of articles critical of the government. ● However, the most concerning attacks on freedom of speech have been physical attacks on journalists, where in the Philippines alone, 18 were killed over the last five years and four in 2020 alone. ● Singapore: Terry Xu Yuanchen, 39, was found guilty in November last year of defaming members of the Cabinet of Singapore by approving the publication of a letter on Sep 4, 2018 that alleged "corruption at the highest echelons".	

	○ https://www.theguardian.com/world/2022/apr/22/singapore-editor-jailed-defamation-corruption-claims-terry-xu-online-citizen ○ The Online Citizen was known for its relatively liberal stance and for featuring criticism of the authorities in the city-state, where media is tightly controlled. It was closed last year after Singapore's media regulator rescinded its licence, stating it had failed to declare the sources of its funding. ○ The regulator the Infocomm Media Development Authority said it was necessary for the site to do so to avoid foreign actors from influencing domestic politics. Xu had said he did not want to betray the confidentiality of the site's subscribers.
TS 3	There is a need to restrict of the freedom of speech of people so as to protect people from larger societal threats as well as smaller individual threats. Unregulated free speech has many problems especially today where the existence of media sites can allow people to post absolutely anything they want and when not checked frequently people can misuse this right to propagate their dangerous goals that is of their self interests as well as destroy an innocents life online. Example:- A 29-year-old self-radicalised Singaporean who was prepared to travel overseas to take up arms was detained in April 2022 under the Internal Security Act. Actually I was wrong AHAHAHHAAHAh the point below is a separate point on how freedom to speech may also allow people to defame each other through cancel culture online; sometimes for the things they were not at fault in. The victim is then shunned from society and sometimes even receive death threats from others which might serve to be dangerous for the person in question. Example:- Blackpink Pink Venom song was parodied by TwoSetViolin on youtube which was done with a clear intention to entertain and show the point of view of the classical musician Paganini instead of throwing shade or hate towards the now renowned girl group members. Fans of Blackpink "Blinks" did not take the video well in their stride and started canceling the musicians by accusing them of bigotry and misogyny. Some even sent them death threats which in this case may threaten the safety of the musicians.

	Smaller individual threats → defamation → cancel culture online → which is protected under the law → if the victim is shunned from society → he has the right to drag the person in court and get remunerated if the person was not in the wrong This does restrict the right to post such content but this is a trade-off that is crucial to make to ensure that innocent individual's dignity is being protected , which is also another fundamental human right that authorities and big media protect thus protecting society as a whole, and through this restriction it would reinstate the idea of the "free society" as people now feel safer to freely access the media sites without burdened or restricted by threats online.
TS 4	There is a need to restrict the freedom of speech of people so as to prevent the proliferation of fake news that can hinder the progress of society and leave society in a disarray. EX- Due to technology, it is not only easy to get the word around fast but also extremely easy to make a piece of information look credible. As a result, it may severely impede the progress of a nation when people believe the false news and make certain choices that may disrupt government's actions or the future of the state. COVID 19 marks running out claims and vaccines being dangerous claims Singapore's decision to curb fake news through POFMA. Whereby checking and validating credible sources helped to make people feel more at ease when they got to know there is enough resources of basic necessities to go around which allowed them to act more rationally and cooperate with their other fellow citizens and government in their fight against the virus. This creates a free society where people can consume information without worrying about fake news. \ Fake news about Haze in 2015 → society to be in a disarray Even social media curbs fake news in one incident unprecedented election saga in 2016, when Russian operatives exploited social media to try to influence the American electorate in favor of Donald Trump ahead of the presidential vote, according to multiple investigations. Social media banned trump from twitter due to many of his false claims about how to deal with covid 19 to the validity of Biden to fuel his own agenda. → The public is unable to make a fair judgment when voting due to uncredible news reports, which can cause an unsuitable candidate to be elected in a leadership position. This can cause a lot of resent and unhappiness among the public, that could cause unrest within the society.

Question	Do events rather than politicians shape the future
Stand	To a large extent, events rather than politicians have shape and will continue to shape the future with the exception of a few cases where politicians have had a big part to play in creating big waves of change in the world.
TS 1	TS:- To a large extent, events in the past rather than politicians have led to the today we experience as it has influenced the international laws that all countries adhere to to maintain the peace and stability in their individual countries that we enjoy today. EX:- Following the atrocities and brutal war crimes in world war 2, nations were in ruins and the human cost of the war was so massive that it could not even be calculated. This caused people, especially government leaders, all around the world to deeply reflect on their actions and arrive at the conclusion that the brutalities committed in the war were a result of what happens when there are a lack of shared rules governing them. As a result, nations can go scot free for any actions that disrupt peace and harm large groups of people for their own national pursuits. With that in mind, countries came together to create international laws with the intent to prevent another tragedy like that. EG:- The deadliest and most destructive war in human history claimed between 40 and 50 million lives, displaced tens of millions of people, and cost more than \$1 trillion to prosecute. Hiroshima and Nagasaki were destroyed with atomic weapons by the US. Japan's troops in Asia enslaved some 200,000 women to act as sex workers ("comfort women") and often acted with a general disregard for human life, especially toward prisoners. The Nazis, they carried out unforgivable and the most abhorrent experiments on their human "subjects". This led to the creation of the UN (United Nations) that serves to protect human rights, fight poverty, encourage disarmament, and promote peace worldwide. The effects of the charter are still as everlasting where human rights are protected and has allowed majority of the world to experience peace and stability without the looming threat of war. Nevertheless, if any country or government leader turns their backs on their rules, they are considered a war criminal and be prosecuted in the UN court, which is the case with the ongoing Russia-Ukraine war caused by Putin. - https://www.npr.org/sections/goatsandsoda/2018/06/28/621112394/the-rules-of-war-are-being-broken-what-exactly-are-they - What Putin did against Ukraine is not left unchallenged- he is considered a war criminal and may be prosecuted in the future - world-60690688
TS 2	However in some cases, politicians rather than events have influenced the future of their country due the the massive amount of power and status that they hold as well as their fantastic ability to lead a country based on what they would like their country to be governed by.

	EX:- In some cases, some politicians in power have the right skill sets to single handedly transform the future of their country. Good leadership skills, foresight, being a strategist, having grit for hard times and genuine concern and care for the country are just some of the leadership qualities needed to change the future for one's country. Such leaders are also highly appraised, loved and trusted by citizens, which makes it even easier for them to implement policies for the betterment of society without facing much resistance from the citizens. EG:- The late Mr Lee Kwan Yew, dubbed the founding father of Singapore has brought Singapore from a third world to a first world country. After the separation of Singapore from Malaysia, everyone thought that as a small city with no natural resources of its own, would not be able to survive. That even even brought Mr Lee to tears. Nevertheless, he rose up from that challenge, displayed grit, and Singapore flourished on the foresightedness of Lee to transform it into the ranks of New York, London and Switzerland as a global financial hub by taking advantage of Singapore's geographical advantage of being a trading port. Mr Lee also implemented policies like housing flats which improved the quality of life of the citizens and allowed them to contribute to the growing economy, built the nation's defense force from ground up through conscription, ruled with honesty and created a team of leaders that had low tolerance for corruption. This enabled Singapore to skyrocket into one of the most successful and well to do countries in the world.
TS 3	To a large extent events rather than politicians shape the future because at the end of the day politicians have only so much power to determine the direction of their country or to influence the behaviors of individuals that would determine the future of the country as mindsets and attitudes are very hard to change regardless of legislations put in place. Example: - SG: People did not counter PAP because of the respect they had for him for bringing SG to the heights it is today. But things are changing, there is a new political culture emerging - <u>"On the one hand is the culture of government that emphasises strong government, effectiveness, a legalistic culture, delivery of public goods and services, and a better life for the people. Critics have characterised the PAP political style as paternalistic," she said.</u> - <u>"On the other hand, many Singaporeans invoke democracy and want to see Singapore evolve into a full-fledged democracy."</u> - <u>She noted that political commentators have asked "why the PAP is asking for a strong mandate, and why it is not more magnanimous in the treatment of opponents".</u> - <u>"(These commentators) would like to see rules applied to</u>

	<u>all political participants fairly, that gerrymandering be restrained,” she said.</u> - <u>While Singaporeans yearn for democratic competition or competitive politics, they appear to be “repulsed” by the competitive, mean politics of some Western democracies, she noted, adding that educated and younger Singaporeans in particular “do not want to see political overkill”.</u>
TS 4	To a large extent events in the past rather than politicians have led to the the today we experience because events today that affect the world globally induces individual governments to create policies revolving around those events to amplify the positive consequences that those events bring or reduce the impact of the negative consequences on their citizens. EX:- Due to the increasing accessibility of travel and trade due to more affordable modes of transport, the world has become increasingly more interconnected and interdependent as compared to the past. Effects of the events taking place in one part of the world has the potential to spread like wildfire to the rest of the world. Thus, it changes the future of the individual states when states implement policies to shield themselves from the negative effects of the event or amplify the positives of it, especially if these policies influences the behavior of each citizen or firm in the country. Example: - What was seen as a one time event of a virus that caused the market in Wuhan to shut down to prevent the spread of it and more deaths, when people traveled from one place to another, this small event was later transformed into a global pandemic. The spread of the virus was so significant that as of November 4, 6 million people globally have died. In the early months of the spread, governments had to step up to contain the spread and prevent further deaths. This led to closing down of national borders, schools, workplaces as people were asked to stay at home. Such developments led to the popularization of online classes and even after the pandemic opened discussions on whether clients could work from home. It also changed the future in where we were able to come up with vaccines to minimize, which taken occasionally can protect us from the virus. Such an event has also left a deep mark on our future in Singapore here as the policies surrounding COVID-19 keep changing according to the extent of spread, with government officials continuously changing mask wearing rules and safe distancing measures. Since its an ongoing event, it is foreseen that much more deadlier and viral strains are going to emerge which would mean we could be looking into a future filled with restrictions to ensure our safety against the virus. EG:- Economic developments —> due to globalization has changed the future of the country from the past and made them what they are

	today → Another example is Vietnam, where globalization has contributed to an increase in the prices for rice, lifting many poor rice farmers out of poverty. As the standard of living increased, more children of poor families left work and attended school. Fast forward another two decades to 2019 and the effects of intensified globalization become clear. The entire distribution of world income shifted up further. Now the middle-income countries enjoyed higher incomes than they did during the 1980s and 1990s. The bottom end of the distribution also did much better, as both China and India and others in Africa and Asia made great strides in raising their incomes and reducing poverty. - Climate change: Governments around the world are forced to pass policies and show greater focus on addressing climate because of worldwide protest (Fridays for Future) - https://www.washingtonpost.com/world/2021/09/24/fridays-future-greta-climate-protests/ - https://www.theguardian.com/science/2021/sep/24/people-in-99-countries-take-part-in-global-climate-strike - https://education.nationalgeographic.org/resource/effects-economic-globalization - https://www.piie.com/blogs/realtime-economic-issues-watch/globalization-enabled-nearly-all-countries-grow-rich-recent -
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SINGAPORE

Quick question analysis

discrimination → against people of race and religion, different sexuality, gender, socio-economic status

eradicated → destroy completely; put an end to

in your society → Singapore

can → yes or no (absolute) but with an exception of few cases

Question	Can discrimination ever be eradicated in your society? (Bijal)
Stand	No, discrimination can never be destroyed completely but with exception

	of few cases where measures can be put in place to reduce discrimination.
TS 1	Discrimination against different sexual orientations cannot be removed completely Singapore is a largely conservative society that does not fully accept people of different sexual orientations. → Talk about how some Singaporeans hold negative perceptions of the LGBTQ community because of censorship laws in Singapore that restricts any neutral or positive representation of LGBTQ individuals, thus preventing the normalisation of people with different orientations → Furthermore, the general consensus in the country towards queer individuals is not as accepting, especially from individuals with strong religious beliefs. They believe that being of a different sexual orientation is against the act of god there is something inherently “sinful” about the homosexual lifestyle, since it supposedly violates the “natural order”. This is especially because religious beliefs are so uniquely resistant to change and calls to revise a religion will inevitably be seen as an assault and legitimacy of that religion → This thus affects laws and policies in Singapore, where the government creates and changes laws and policies based on the general view that all the citizens in the country hold. Although Singapore has recently repealed 377A, members of the community still do not face equality as the sole purpose of repealing 377A was to strengthen the protection of the constitution by instead imposing laws to uphold the definition of traditional marriage which refers to the union between a man and woman only, and these laws thus naturally prevents members of the community to have the same rights as any other citizens like the right to marry or buy a flat via BTO, thus being systematically discriminated against. . BT: To extend illustrative range, you could talk about transgenderism and the lack of acceptance thereof in Singapore. Furthermore, this discrimination is also similarly faced by transgender individuals in both schools and workplace where school administrators had imposed on high performing trans individuals to leave school or prevent them from transitioning while in the workplace many of them are denied job opportunities, in healthcare restricted access to sexual and reproductive health and the list goes on. This further marginalises members of this community and thus they face a lot of discrimination. https://sg.news.yahoo.com/80-of-singaporeans-say-lgbtq-community-still-faces-discrimination-survey-090136467.html?guccounter=1&guce_referrer=aHR0cHM6Ly93d3cuZ29vZ2xLmNvbS8&guce_referrer_sig=AQAAAHN2K6nUHagVW YWBoyCi9Zps5irj7sRejiYbLYGe tMVzwh3hpDg9O9zOUZ9KqZQ57KKbIDHV-5FbkbGFnMMLuIT5qqXO40iP1e19ctVRtRBAanZhJE6mxHPMzOZnE4eXq-ppJyZyLnoYy0IYZprjUNsfesYJhsIXpwYrOt3VL https://the-singapore-lgbt-encyclopaedia.fandom.com/wiki/Discrimination_against_transgender_people_in_Singapore

	BT: To achieve greater depth of insight in this para, you can consider explaining why conservative beliefs that are deeply rooted in fundamentalist religious worldviews are so hard to correct, in the EX phase. ← religion is a very sensitive issue since, for the ultra-religious, faith is a core part of their personal identity. Calls to revise their fundamentalist religious beliefs will therefore likely be seen as an attack on their very person. Moreover, religious fundamentalism makes a virtue of faithful adherence to established principles/doctrines, and so any attempt to moderate extreme religious beliefs will be seen as an attempt to convince faithful adherents to compromise on their values (i.e. to come to a compromise is to be “unfaithful” to their God).✓
TS 2	However, in Singapore, certain laws and policies are put in place to reduce the amount of discrimination specifically people of different race and religion face. (Balance) → EX to mention how Singapore is a small country who has a racially diverse population and a melting pot of ethnic cultures and diverse religious traditions. Therefore, there is a heavy emphasis placed in order to promote racial and religious harmony to prevent small tensions between racial groups as that could exacerbate into even greater conflicts between racial groups that could lead to societal fragmentation and in worst cases riots (like the 1964 racial riots in Singapore caused by political tensions between the Malays and Chinese and which lead to many being injured and was even considered the worst and most prolonged conflict in history) → The maintenance of the racial harmony act that aims to change people's behaviours and “nudge good behaviour” which would include a soft approach to address the offences with the intent of healing the hurt the perpetrator has caused rather than intensifying feelings of hatred by pressing down harsh methods on them which may thus be more effective as it can help to curb the individual's hatred towards another race or religion and help to better promote racial harmony. BT: You need to give some evaluation of the effectiveness or likely effectiveness of such measures. Maybe you can say that these measures are likely to have a positive effect in reducing outward shows of discrimination. (But subtle forms of discrimination are another matter! ← You can discuss this in Para 3)✓
TS 3	Nevertheless, discrimination against race and religion cannot be completely and permanently eliminated because prejudiced mindsets of individuals towards other races cannot be easily changed as it stems from stereotypes and rooted in deep cultural practices. (Counter to balance) EX- Can be derived from Mr Bobs notes on the evolutionary example on why people have deep seated beliefs and hold stereotypes against a certain community → tribal example and innate theory that we are more comfortable and gravitate towards members of our own community than

others and thus small negative encounters with other individuals that are from a different racial group or community would affirm all the negative notion and preconceptions we hold against them.

Examples:- Give examples on how Indians are seen as smelly (personal experience) but also examples on how on a livestream of a Korean streamer vacationing in Singapore, a Singaporean auntie came up to her telling her that "Singapore is safe, but you do not want to be raped by Indians" and she proceeded to clarify that the Indians she is referring to are Bangladeshis.

EX:- (2nd tier) While outright blasphemous comments like the examples above are blatantly discriminatory in nature, there still exists a subtle form of racism in Singapore that makes the above-mentioned law ineffective as these forms of racism are very prevalent and less obvious, making it hard to identify and punish those who also engage in this form of discrimination.

Examples:- For example, there is a rise in "casual" racism in Singapore which manifests in the form of jokes or casual remarks. These are especially annoying for the victims since they are often expected to take them in their stride and not treat them as seriously, especially when it is said by people they are personally familiar with. Some include being preposterous comments like "If I turn off the lights, I won't be able to see you" to "You are a black monkey".

Elaborate:- are extremely harmful as a prolonged exposure to such brash comments can cause victims to feel insecure about their physical appearance, ashamed about their ethnicity and even worse, feel like they don't belong in Singapore's society and find ways to compensate for that by either dissociating themselves from their own race or even internalise the negative stereotypes their friends feed to them about their own race.

<https://www.todayonline.com/big-read/big-read-short-rooting-out-everyday-racism-1932656>

<https://youthopia.sg/read/casual-racism-is-not-just-an-issue-for-the-minorities-in-singapore-to-solve/>

TLDR:- How attitudes cannot be changed and that where laws are only designed to punish and deter discriminatory behaviour but cannot discern motives and change attitudes where someone could carry out discriminatory behaviour but disguise them.

<https://www.straitstimes.com/singapore/racism-still-exists-in-singapore-but-identity-politics-must-not-take-root-says-lawrence>

BT: OK no complaints about this para ✓

TS 4	Discrimination in the form of discrimination against gender equality can never be eradicated completely because of ingrained systemic gender roles which tips the balance, causing the other gender, specifically women, to bear significant burden and lose out on career opportunities. EX:- Singapore is still a relatively conservative society where patriarchal norms and value are being upheld where in the workplace, some women continue obstacles due to perceptions that certain jobs should be performed by women and others by men and at home, there are entrenched views that women are primary caregivers while men are main breadwinners. This is especially because from young we have internalized these fixed gender roles when we see our parents submitting to these “systemic gender roles” through their behaviours at home and as we grow up we subconsciously end up mimicking their behaviour and ways at home which further affirms the existence of the fixed gender roles. For example, a video titled Gift To Our Next Generation, featured different children reacting to household chores and caregiving duties at home based on their parents' behaviour at home, and unsurprisingly the kids tasked with mimicking their mothers showed more initiative to uptake household duties as compared to kids mimicking their fathers, further solidifying the endless cycle of the existence systemic gender stereotypes. TLDR:- https://www.channelnewsasia.com/singapore/the-big-read-singapore-gender-equality-women-roles-1968061 (this article talks about how since women are expected to bear the responsibility of the caretaker, they end up having a wage gap after they return from a maternity leave and because of this sometimes seen as unprofitable and also even if laws were implemented to allow for equal opportunities it would not work because if behaviours were not changed (ie if the father does not share the burden of taking care of the house with the mother, the same idea of stereotypical gender roles would be ingrained in the children and the cycle of problematic rigid gender roles would continue affecting equality in opportunities in women) (Example) BT: To achieve greater depth of insight in this para, you can consider explaining the root/contributory causes of these “ingrained systemic gender roles” in the EX phase. ✓
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SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

(where over here it has a bit of the elements of tourism)

Question	Are global tourism and travel still necessary when everything can be experienced online?
Stand	Yes they are although some may argue that technology can very well replace the need for global tourism and travel.
TS 1	TS: They are essential because low income people in nations that heavily depend on tourism and travel may lose their jobs as they may not have access to the technology to earn their livelihood through online means causing the states' economy to suffer. EX: Small island nations' large percentage of GDP is derived from the influx of overseas travelers like British Virgin Islands, Malta and Maldives just to name a few due to their appeal of sandy beaches and exceptionally picturesque landscape. Many of the residents there earn their livelihoods through working at tourist hotspots when tourists physically spend their time there. However, with the shift of such tourism services to be done through online means, such residents may lose their livelihoods (especially those who are from the low income group of their society) as their job may become obsolete due to the absence of the tourists at such spots, given the labor intensive characteristics of tourism related jobs EG: According to UNWTO and WTTC, among the 330 million jobs linked to tourism, many of these jobs are undertaken by more economically vulnerable groups, hence helping to decrease the gap in income disparity and absolute poverty for developing and

	developed countries → Given the rise in COVID 19, these low income individuals are often the ones being laid off from work → The low skilled nature and low education of tourism jobs makes it difficult for them to attract high wages in the first place and be adaptable to join other “teleworking” positions in the same industry which justifies their limited accessibility to technological resources like computers and cameras needed to work in the tourism sector through social media → causing them to lose their jobs EV:- Thus an over-emphasis on online tourism services can cause the income disparity to increase again due to increasing unemployment of low income individuals which not only decreases their quality of life based on how they can sustain their livelihood, but it may also lead to the closing down of jobs in the tourism sector that used to bring in part of the revenue which makes up the country’s real national income due to low demand for it. Coupled with the fact that most of the employees in such industries are unable to adapt to shifting their business or their work to be done online due to low funding by the state and largely low monetary capability of employees, and that the country heavily relies on the revenue generated from such jobs, the states’ real national income will be severely impacted.
TS 2 (Counter)	TS:- Some may argue that technology is so well-developed that people can fulfill their purpose of travel through the comfort of their home. EX:- Some people may argue that technology is so well-developed that people can fulfill their purpose of travel through the comfort of their home through online services, thus not needing travel and global tourism. It is claimed that In today’s world, digitalisation and inventions have allowed for any normal civilian with a high speed internet and a mobile device and in some cases a VR headset to to have access to virtual tourism which would give them a holistic view of the country of choice where they will be able to fly over terrains, swim in lakes without being wet and the list goes on. Thus, the argument goes, users can feel like they are actually in the country without needing to spend any large fees on transportation or accommodation and in fact feel less exhaustion from their “travels”. EG:- People who claim in-person travel is obsolete due to technology also point to similar online tours like the tour of “Forest of Horohoro” in Japan, ‘Travel in Paris and Its Suburbs” in France and “Go to meet the people of Sri Lanka! Online tour” in Sri Lanka which was especially conducted through Zoom which allowed people stuck at home due to the pandemic and desperate to visit other countries have the ability to experience their desired countries as if they were actually there. Advocates of digital travel also highlight the advent of such social streaming services like Zoom as stated earlier has also allowed students and employees worldwide that were unable to travel

	to the country of choice for education and business related purposes were now able to seamlessly interact with the people in other countries and build an understanding around their culture and the different types of people around the world. EV: Supposedly, this is because easy access to such social streaming sites allowed for greater exposure to people of diverse and differing backgrounds, which would mean understanding of people from different countries which would also happen if one were to visit the country as well as ensure that their inability to travel does not hinder necessary work as well as increased convenience of staying at home making global tourism less appealing and essential as compared to online sites. (yellow highlighted are examples)
TS 3 (Rebuttal)	TS:- However, this claim is a stretch because sources online are unable to provide the full sensory experience of the desired place of visit as there are many aspects like the food and culture to what makes traveling memorable to a person that cannot be replicated through a screen, making global tourism essential. EX:- Based on the above example, Zoom only gives a 2D experience of the place and except for the sense of sight and sound it is not able to give the viewer the experience of being in the desired country of visit. Well it may be argued that VR on the other hand has the capability to recreate the environment of the desired place of choice by mimicking the experience of being there through various stimulus which may cause the viewer to not only see and hear but also “feel” what it might be like to be there, it can never replace the actual reality because it can never meet the physiological needs of our body like eating and interacting with the members of the tourist destination. In order to fully appreciate the county, one would have to indulge themselves in the culture of the country by engaging in their traditions. EG:- For example, one who would attend the Japan tour in the forest would not be able to smell the fresh misty scent of the forest or freely take pictures of themselves there. Furthermore, they would not get to communicate with the locals there which makes them a tourist at that country at a superficial level and thus not a traveler. Not experiencing the food or how locals there conduct themselves there may cause them to miss out on creating core memories of that place due to not being able to satisfy their physiological needs (struggling :((()
TS 4	The increased appeal of online tourism might result in the romanticisation of the country to attract more viewers which may cause viewers to have a false perception about the country, making global tourism and travel essential to prevent disillusioning netizens. [Revised: Additionally, from the perspective of the tourist

	himself, a physical visit to the country is still absolutely necessary because there is no other way to gain a deep and accurate understanding of the society; online tours have a tendency to only present a romanticised version of the country.] EX:- In order to get more netizens online to join their online tourism services to generate more revenue, they only show videos and photos of their more attractive sites of their country or fine tune such videos and photos to enhance the beauty of the landscapes or sites that they are trying to promote to get more visitors to come to the tourist site that they are promoting, which unfortunately, may not be as beautiful or worth visiting in real life, causing the netizens to be at a loss. EG:- As per the report of Yan, 2010 about the use of some consumer-generated media sites are carrying out illicit acts and some managers are paying webmasters to delete or avoid consumers negative comments as well as hiring individuals to post negative comments or reviews about competitors' products and services which makes the trustworthiness of UGC (user generated content) sources questionable. → emphasize on how UGC seems credible because they are seen as comments posted by people who have experienced the place yet and thus more reliable also cannot be trusted https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S240584402030284X EV:- Such trends show how it is easy to manipulate information online especially ones that are reliable to hide the nasty truths some of these countries may be trying to hide from tourist whether it be hiding the large income disparities between groups of people in their country, corrupt begging organizations as seen in India or the seemingly naïve innocent horse riding services on the beach that end up scamming you and leaving holes in your pocket in Pakistan, which can all be experienced if one truly sees it physically for himself. All of these are hidden in attempts to raise revenue through tourism which would be hindered if the image of the country is seen as unsafe or on a superficial level- ugly to visit and thus not worth spending on online services on viewing such countries due to the preconceived negative perspective one has about the country.
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Question	Examine the view that scientists are concerned only with knowledge, not morality. (Note:- I took some points from suggested essay outlines)
Stand	In most cases, scientists are not really concerned with morality as they take a neutral stand in the ethical viewpoint of their research with the exception of a

	few extreme cases where they saw an urgent need to assess the morality of their research or invention.
TS 1	TS + EX :- Scientists are not so concerned with morality of their research and inventions as they are so preoccupied with knowledge that they have readily put aside moral concerns. Though at this point in history, scientific racism has been thoroughly debunked as pseudoscience, there was a time where its advocates treated it as a serious science. EG:- Early proponents of this theory variously believed, for instance, that each race had separate origins, and were designed to inhabit different regions on earth; or that although all humans descended from white ancestors, degradation due to environmental factors had led to the emergence of the 'Mongolian', 'Negroid', '(Native) American', and 'Malay' race, as German anatomist Johann Blumenbach put them; or even that blackness was a hereditary skin condition, as was proposed by American physician Benjamin Rush². In each of these cases, men of science, in their pursuit of knowledge, tried to come up with schema to explain racial differences. Unfortunately, in their eagerness to do so, they ended up promoting abhorrent worldviews, giving pseudoscientific ammunition to racists who, to this day, try to justify their racist attitudes and actions with 'facts' culled from the body of claims made by the obsolete field of scientific racism. • https://www.getrevue.co/profile/bhq/issues/there-is-no-cure-for-negroidism-26651 7
TS 2	Nevertheless, to a small extent, scientists do care about morality and it's not only concerned with knowledge, especially since their inventions have the capability to affect the whole world negatively or positively. Sometimes, scientists make discoveries that have the potential to be made into something deadly - which is something they did not foresee happening when they made the discovery. One famous example is EG:- Albert Einstein discovery in the theory of relativity $E=mc^2$ which is clearly demonstrated by the atomic bombs and Einstein did not know that this principle would be used to make atomic bombs and the governments actions greatly influenced his actions whereby the looming threat of Hitlers power in Germany in invading a lot of the world, Einstein decided to encourage US to build the bombs only for it to be used on bombing Japan which could have been avoided if tensions between people in power (governments) would have been resolved in other ways. Dubbed as the angel of death, Alfred Nobel was responsible for creating many different types of explosives, which led to the death of many. Upset by this, he made an explosive so destructive enough that it would be able to "end all wars". However, wars were still ongoing and the annihilation was even worse. Thus, as Einstein puts it, to "atone for this 'accomplishment' and to relieve his conscience, he ("Nobel") instituted his award for the promotion

	of peace” EV:- Serves to show how scientists like Alfred Nobel and Albert Einstein were genuinely concerned about the usage of his theory and the moral consequences that follow if the nuclear bomb was used which led to his prompt action in trying to prevent the use of that invention.
TS 3	TS:- However, scientists are still expected to follow some ethical guidelines set by authorities to prevent exploitation of individuals in scientific research and not following those guidelines have severe repercussions to their career. Thus for utmost practical reasons, they follow these guidelines out of obligation to uphold the dignity of international law. EX:- Such guidelines are usually set by the authorities and the ethics committee which serves the purpose to protect individuals from scientists conducting experiments without careful safety considerations and also to keep scientists at check to not cross the line while experimenting on humans which helps to retain some humanity in the scientific experiments done and to ensure that uninformed individuals are not taken advantage of. EG:- Some examples of the effects of lack of proper regulations: the heinous medical experiments done on human subjects were most commonly from during world war two. From the Nazis, to the Imperial Japan, they carried out unforgivable and the most abhorrent experiments on their human “subjects”. One of the most infamous being subjecting the prisoners of war to freeze in subzero temperatures in the sea naked for hours and then trying to see which of the horrendous methods would be effective in resuscitating them, causing in many deaths. EV:- Therefore, certain regulations are required to ensure scientists act and behave in accordance so as to preserve human rights and any scientists accused of not following would be answerable to the law.
TS 4	TS :- Scientists are primarily concerned with facts about the physical world, which means that they seek understanding of how things are, and not how things should be—which is the domain of morality. EX:- In the 1700s, influential philosopher David Hume famously articulated the is-ought problem: no ethical conclusion may be validly inferred from any set of purely factual data.¹ (Scientific investigation yields brute facts about the natural world, but moral truths are in an abstract domain that cannot be reached by instruments designed to measure physical quantities.) The logic here is simple but unassailable. And to this day, no one has convincingly disproved this simple axiom. It is telling that whenever there is a breach of research ethics in science, and the scientific community expresses outrage at the offending party, the principles they appeal to are not discerned by

	scientific inquiry, but rather drawn from other domains, such as public morality. EG:- For instance, when it was revealed that Chinese scientist He Jiankui had illicitly performed CRISPR-based gene edits on embryos, the entire scientific community were up in arms because research ethics had been gravely violated—transparency had been eschewed; undue risks had been taken with a technology that had not been adequately tested; and ethical issues surrounding consent had been completely disregarded. But one should note that transparency, due caution, and respect for consent are not principles that are derived through scientific investigation. Rather, they are part of the moral framework that exists outside of science itself, and which guide ethical scientists in their scientific pursuits. https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/hume/
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MEDIA + VIOLENCE

Question	Does violence in the visual media portray reality or encourage the unacceptable
Stand	Violence in the media to a large extent does not portray reality but mostly seeks to encourage the unacceptable.
TS 1	Violence in the media to a large extent does not portray reality but mostly seeks to encourage the unacceptable because the violence portrayed in media, specifically video games is usually unrealistic to retain its attractiveness which incentivises kids to play but it influences aggressiveness in teenagers and kids. PMC8293336 Actually, studies agree on the negative impact of violent video games on aggressive behavior. Several meta-analyses have examined violent VGs [6,7,8,103] and, although they vary greatly in terms of how many studies they include, they seem to agree with each other. The most comprehensive [8] showed that violent VGs, gradually and unconsciously, as a result of repeated exposure to justified and fun violence, would increase aggressive thoughts, affect and behavior, physiological persistent alertness, and would desensitize players to violence and to the pain and suffering of others, supporting a perceptual and cognitive bias to attribute hostile intentions to

	others. Evident in how an 11 year old boy influenced by a first-person shooter game, "Natural Selection," had worn a t-shirt emblazoned with its name when he shot a teacher and himself to death and left 6 others injured. The governor of that state in Mexico where the shooting happened said he believed the boy had tried to "recreate" the game. Such games are also highly addictive and teenagers spend hours each day playing such games with their friends. What's worse is that in such games violence is rewarded according to one's kill streak- the more kills made in a row, the higher their points. hyper realistic games like VR exaggerate features and the theatrics of the game to immerse the player into the game which further incentivises the person to try it in real life due to the addictive nature of such violent game and the "relaxation" factor it brings to them. Need to find examples of this
TS 2	In some cases, violence in media does portray reality where in certain documentaries and informative shows it does so to increase awareness about the real life atrocities committed by people in history, and thus discourages the unacceptable. EX:- Many countries show the full portrayal of history especially with major events like world war 2 and world war 1 to educate humanity of their past mistakes. Censoring violence in their local media would only serve to sanitize history and would lose its purpose to serve as a grim reminder to individuals in the present about the consequences of war and violence. Furthermore, it may also be seen as a disrespect to the other countries that have suffered at the hands of the host country when the violence is censored as it would seem like the the host country is not taking full responsibility for their past errors. EG:- Germany example on how they reconciled with their past and took responsibility for the atrocities they committed in the past. The Austwitz camps are still up with full explanation as to what happen and even rules surrounding how visitors should behave emphasises the seriousness of their actions and gravity of consequences which serve to remind citizens how unrestrained violence brings out the worst in people discouraging the unacceptable. https://www.bbc.com/news/magazine-21226068 Teachers in Japan have to teach Japan's history to students from the time

period of the earliest civilization to present day in 1 year. By the time it is the end of year, teachers do not have enough time to teach about WW2 in detail, often glossing over Japan's involvement in WW2 or telling students to read through the topic on their own.

Limited mention of Japan's violence in WW2:

- There was one page on other events leading up to the Sino-Japanese war in 1937 - including one line, in a footnote, about the massacre that took place when Japanese forces invaded Nanjing - the Nanjing Massacre, or Rape of Nanjing.
- There was another sentence on the Koreans and the Chinese who were brought to Japan as miners during the war, and one line, again in a footnote, on "comfort women" - a prostitution corps created by the Imperial Army of Japan.
- There was also just one sentence on the atomic bombings of Hiroshima and Nagasaki.



Mariko's Japanese textbook: Only a footnote on the Nanjing massacre

- While school pupils in Japan may read just one line on the massacre, children in China are taught in detail not just about the Rape of Nanjing but numerous other Japanese war crimes, though these accounts of the war are sometimes criticised for being overly anti-Japanese.

	• The same can be said about South Korea, where the education system places great emphasis on our modern history. This has resulted in very different perceptions of the same events in countries an hour's flying time apart. • One of the most contentious topics there is comfort women. Fujioka believes they were paid prostitutes. But Japan's neighbours, such as South Korea and Taiwan, say they were forced to work as sex slaves for the Japanese army. Without knowing these debates, it is extremely difficult to grasp why recent territorial disputes with China or South Korea cause such an emotional reaction among our neighbours. The sheer hostility shown towards Japan by ordinary people in street demonstrations seems bewildering and even barbaric to many Japanese television viewers. https://theconversation.com/japans-way-of-remembering-world-war-ii-still-irrefuriates-its-neighbours-45663 - Censorship of WW2 atrocities by Japan in their media and education system https://www3.nhk.or.jp/nhkworld/en/news/backstories/1992/ - Censorship of cholera in Japan after ww2
TS 3	Violence in media to a large extent does not portray reality but mostly seeks to encourage the unacceptable because violence portrayed is to elevate the theatrics of the movie to attract more viewership which in turn influence gullible and impressionable audiences to attempt to mimic what was shown. EX:- Some films are packed with gratuitous violence which crosses a certain line of morality. This especially appeals to people who enjoy watching gore flick whereby it satisfies their basic instinct of aggression. Characterised by blood and gore, such films have extreme violence in it that is exaggerated out of proportion to obviously appeal to these groups of people that enjoy watching it. Watching such films also distorts one's perception on how they feel towards violence. In this case, one should feel afraid of violence as it could pose a threat to their lives but such films only serve to fuel the desire to engage in and even experience violence which serves to prop up violence in real life as well. EG:- studies from researchers at the University of Augsburg, Germany and the University of Wisconsin-Madison US found that people drawn to violent content because they anticipate other benefits, such as thrill and suspense

	and the findings also suggest that such hedonistic pleasures are only part of the story about why people willingly expose ourselves to scenes of bloodshed and aggression. Even violence has spread to children shows which initially seem really kids friendly but also display extremely uncomfortable gory scenes. Cartoons like Happy Tree friends and Gumball are just some of the examples. https://theconversation.com/glamorising-violent-offenders-with-true-crime-shows-and-podcasts-needs-to-stop-121806 - Glamorising violent offenders with 'true crime' shows and podcasts needs to stop
TS 4	Nevertheless, violence in media to a large extent does not portray reality but mostly seeks to encourage the unacceptable because the violence portrayed in crime documentaries may not be the most objective which in turn retraumatized victims of the violent actions or be the subject of profit. → desensitizing → traumatizing → insensitive EG:- The loved ones of 1999 murder victim Hae Min Lee said the attention from Serial "reopened old wounds" for their family. Despite this, HBO have adapted that case into a new documentary series - The Case Against Adnan Syed - which follows on from where the record-breaking podcast took off. A Netflix series charting Avery's wrongful conviction on sexual assault charges and re-incarceration for murder became a sensation on its December 2015 debut. Hundreds of thousands of people have since signed petitions demanding his and his nephew's acquittal. A second series has already been released and legal appeals are ongoing. he international spotlight has brought uncomfortable attention to the county and its city namesake. Now, tourists drive over to the Avery family's Salvage Yard to take selfies. A firefighter tells me the local police have been forced to moderate Facebook comments because of abuse. I'm told threats have forced other officials off social media altogether. The Cream City Cannibal tour takes visitors around Walker's Point - the area where serial killer Jeffrey Dahmer lured some of his victims from gay bars.

	https://www.abajournal.com/news/article/can-true-crime-documentaries-do-more-harm-than-good https://www.bbc.com/news/world-us-canada-47474996
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<https://www.routledge.com/blog/article/what-is-the-connection-between-media-violence-and-real-world-violence>

<https://www.apa.org/topics/video-games/violence-harmful-effects>

<https://berkeliumin.home.blog/2020/04/04/does-violence-in-the-visual-media-portray-reality-or-encourage-the-unacceptable/>

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Group content building

Organization:- UNSC (United Nations Security Council)

Countries involved:- 15 member states with 5 having veto power ie US, UK, Russia, China, France (P5)

Goal:- Maintenance of international peace and security and developing friendly relations among nations

Effective in ensuring that international community agrees to authorize action to protect human beings rather than individual states and that countries do not stand idly when atrocities are committed

Examples

(+) Followed by the atrocities committed during interstate conflicts between Bosnia and Rwanda, the policy R2P (Responsibility to protect) was introduced which protects citizens against war crimes which helps bring nations together when individual states are unable to → Example:- China and Russia agreed to human intervention in 2011 stopping Qaddafi from possible crimes against humanity in Libya

(+) Nuclear non proliferation treaty → Russia and US were constrained from modernizing their arsenal → helped understanding of what was legitimate or illegitimate → prevented possible escalation ie nuclear war

Ineffective because of two reasons; 1. Actions are counterproductive and may impede other rights 2. Flaws in their beliefs which reduces their credibility and may cause increased tensions

Examples

[1] (-) In order to help with Afghanistan's political struggles after the Taliban left, they promoted democratizing the society and establishing a rule of law which firstly goes against the states right to "choose its political, economic, social and cultural system" and secondly was ineffective as it failed and led to a government that was ineffective and corrupt and resulted

[2] (-) UNSC council authorized US led military action in invading Iraq due to Iraq's occupation in Kuwait in 1990 and there was a lack of inclusion of other relevant states outside of the council as well as the continued importance of powerful states for the intervention rather than UN itself pointing to a slight partiality in the system. Furthermore vetoes* did not stop US from proceeding to invade Iraq which was also fuelled by its self interest which caused UNSC to deviate from its institutional constraints which pointed to flaws in the theory of liberal institutionalism* on which UNSC was founded. This not only shows the ineffectiveness of their solution of a veto but also sparks doubts about their reliability, which reduces countries' willingness to fall back on them to increase their peace and stability.

*veto- a constitutional right to reject a decision or proposal by a lawmaking body

*liberal institutionalism - is a theory of international relations that holds that international cooperation between states is feasible and sustainable, and that such cooperation can reduce conflict and competition.

Question	Consider the view that globalisation has harmed rather than improved international relations today <i>QA:- globalization → ideas, knowledge, goods and services and spread around the world and there is increasing interconnectedness and interdependence and interaction and integration</i>
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	<i>International relations → the ties between countries</i> <i>Today → Present day</i>
Stand	Globalisation has largely improved international relations between countries rather than harming them, although in some exceptional cases there has been some strain in the ties of the countries.
TS 1	Globalization has largely improved international relations rather than harmed because the increasing interdependence has caused countries to have to rely on one another for her own prosperity and thus keep good ties with each other . EX- Specifically countries are heavily interdependent on trade which would thus increase the cost of conflict and would thus promote peace between the countries as being in good relations with each other helps to upkeep individual national interests like boosting the economy or increasing the quality of life of citizens EG- According to a study commissioned by the US-China Business Council (USCBC), the US-China trade war had caused a peak job loss of 245000 jobs. The study estimates that US exports to China support 1.2 million American jobs and that the Chinese MNCs directly employ 197000 Americans, while US companies invested \$105 billion in China in 2019. Globalization has led to greater economic interdependence, and any sort of conflict would inflict harm on all parties. This discourages escalation of tensions between countries.
TS 2	In some cases, globalization has harmed international relations because of a country's prioritization of their self interests over another country's which led to severe negative impacts for the other country due to increasing interconnectedness and thus led to tensions. By increasing the intensity and frequency of interaction between different states, globalization has exacerbated the existing differences between states. This is more likely to ignite tensions between states. E.g. Covid19 has saw the movement of people across the porous borders between Thailand and Myanmar as people fled back to their homeland to avoid lockdowns and the dearth of employment. This led to a rise in xenophobia as countries engage in a blame game as to who is responsible for the spike in Covid19 cases in their respective countries. Sources: https://www.nytimes.com/2020/12/08/world/asia/covid-thailand-myanmar-migrants-border.html
TS 3	Nevertheless, globalization has largely improved international relations rather than harmed as it has led to people being exposed to a diversity of

	culture. EX- When countries are interconnected with each other, they not only trade in goods and services but are also open to cultural influences from other countries which is spread through food and entertainment. When citizens of the domestic country experiences and likes a cultural aspect of another country (which is brought in through trade), it becomes popularised. This influence will cause governments to be incentivised to continue their partnership with the country whose culture is popularised in the domestic country, to ensure good relations so that their citizens can continue to enjoy these cultural influences. In some cases, the enjoyment of such cultural phenomena can allow citizens to look past their country's strained relationship with the other country due to past conflicts and move on, which also makes it easier for the governments of the two countries to come together and reconcile and strengthen their ties, improving international relations. Example: you can talk about Japan and Korea —> How Japan and Korea had alot of tension because of WWII, whereby the war caused them to have strained relationships where citizens of both countries negatively viewed each other and were not able to see eye to eye. —> Due to the introduction of the Hallyu wave in Korea, 35% of Japanses respondents in the Korean Culture and Information Service survey said they viewed Korea postively and such views outnumbered the negative views. They also reported that “unlike their parents’ generation they are less affected by the historic squabbles between two neighbours that inflame elderly patriots on both sides”
TS 4	Globalization has largely improved international relations rather than harmed because due to increased volatility in the world, countries face a global issue rather than issues only on a national level, which incentivises international co-operation and thus strengthening ties between countries. EX- When one countries experience a major disaster many countries feel a shockwave of after effects of that major disaster, whether it be a natural disaster, economic crisis or war between two countries in another part of the world. The phrase, “when US sneezes, the world catches a cold” is a popularized phrase that came about after observing the common pattern of the economic downturn on the whole world after US faces one in their own economy. However this not only applies to US, but also for decades now we seen how events in the other parts of the world are able to significantly affect countries who are not even part of those negative events. Therefore, to a certain extent in order to protect themselves from the ripple effects of the happenings around the world, countries team up to find out solutions to help the countries in question so as to negate the negative effects of the event to the rest of the countries and to some extent even protect their national interest.

	Example:- When a cargo ship MV Wakashio ran aground on a coral reef in the Indian Ocean in 2020, it unleashed a vast oil spill and since Mauritius is not geared up to deal with a catastrophe of this size, other countries have sent experts to help as the effects of oil spill had the potential to affect a larger region, and this caused many team of experts from France, UN, Japan and UK to investigate and help with clean up efforts.
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Question	"In the global age we inhabit, there is no justification for national boundaries." How far do you agree
Stand	I agree with this statement to a large extent because globalization has led to an increased interconnectedness and interdependence between countries whereby putting up boundaries may lead to practical and ethical consequences, although in some cases, national boundaries are put up to protect their individual states from the negative effects of such a phenomenon, which is seen as justifiable when actions are taken with the intent of safeguarding the citizens.
TS 1	I agree to this statement to a large extent such that keeping national boundaries can cause more harm to the economy than benefits, not just the country in question, but almost the whole world. This is especially globalization has lead to an increased interconnectedness and and interdependence between countries, that has led to the advent of trade all around the world causing boundaries between countries to be blurred. Putting up national boundaries would reduce the flow of goods and services and factors of production from the domestic country to the rest of the world which would reduce the ability of the domestic country to increase their national income but also hinder the production processes of their domestic firms who rely on imported goods to do so. This causes a reduction in the production of the goods and services by the domestic firms, which would reduce the demand for labor and causes an increase in retrenchment of workers. EG:- according to the Tax Foundation's Taxes and Growth model, President Trump's proposal to raise taxes by approximately \$37.5 billion annually (by levying a 25 percent tariff on \$150 billion worth of Chinese imports) would reduce the long-run level of GDP by 0.1 percent, or about \$20 billion.^[34] The smaller economy would result in 0.1 percent lower wages and 79,000 fewer full-time equivalent jobs. The tariffs will also make the U.S. tax code less progressive because the increased tax burden would fall hardest on lower- and middle-income household https://taxfoundation.org/impact-of-tariffs-free-trade/ Furthermore, it has been shown that trade flow disruptions in one country due to the amount of tariffs can greatly affect the global economy especially when in order to produce a good, its production process takes place in different parts of the country. This would mean that if there is a tariff placed by the domestic economy to reduce the import of the good, it would hinder the production

	process of the good which would hurt the supply chain and affect the firms situated in different parts of the world. Other countries are hit indirectly through weaker demand for their own exports, either through supply chains or in response to weaker global economic growth. These effects outweigh any potential gains from trade diversion to avoid tariffs. In the protectionism scenario, the level of global real GDP is reduced 0.1% this year, 0.8% in 2019, and 1.4% in 2020. https://ihsmarkit.com/solutions/us-china-trade-war-impacts.html
TS 2	TS + EX:- Nevertheless, some countries decide to shield themselves from globalization and put up a wall around their country due to the negative effects of globalization on the country, mainly to safeguard the citizens of the country, for the interests of the nation. Many countries like the US, India, China, South and North Korea are very committed to establishing strong physical boundaries to protect the citizens of their country. By doing this they are trying help to improve national defense through preventing illegal immigration. In recent decades , terrorism is on the rise and most notably, terrorist events like 9/11 have incentivised governments to put their defenses up as an obligatory and justifiable action to protect their citizens. EG:-- hiiiiii sorry i jus need some examples for my above mentioned point EX:- Economic boundaries make sense as a way of insulating the country from too many uncertainties from the outside economic environment. This can also be seen by how some countries actively try to avoid influx of migrants due to the risk of burdening the government budget to provide for them. EG:- An example could be the UK voting out of Brexit recently, due to the migrant issue and funding of the EU especially for the less productive countries. In such cases, boundaries do make some sense, especially if countries want to make a clear stand about safeguarding their economy and their citizens and not providing for the economically less productive countries. https://theculture.sg/2016/08/national-boundaries-make-little-geographical-or-economic-sense-nowadays-discuss/ https://www.migrationpolicy.org/article/borders-and-walls-do-barriers-det-er-unauthorized-migration
TS 3	Nevertheless, I still agree with this statement to a large extent because it is not justified to keep national boundaries as it causes them to turn their backs on humanitarian issues like the refugee crisis where

	countries uphold a moral responsibility to take in refugees. According to the UNHCR (United Nation High Commissioner for Refugees), seeking asylum is a fundamental human right where everyone has the right to life and liberty and everyone has the right to freedom from fear. It is thus inherently and morally unjustified for states to shun and refuse refugees from entering their country, especially when they have the resources and ability to do so. EG:- The shutdown of the Western Balkans route to Europe has left thousands of refugees facing an uncertain future, where many are living vicariously in unsafe accommodation. This is due to the fact that European borders have been militarized with aggressive border patrols, with little consideration for human dignity. This resulted in these refugees being abused by smugglers and freezing in the cold environment, which also caused lives to be lost. EX:- Furthermore, it is a flawed argument to say that local jobs are being threatened with the influx of such refugees because in reality, the initial investment in taking in refugees allows for countries to experience economic growth. When refugees enter the country, they bring with them entrepreneurial skills, knowledge and culture which can be extremely beneficial when they are initially supported well by the government. This is because it would allow them to build businesses from ground up, fill up jobs in the job market locals are unwilling to do and bring in expertise into the jobs they uptake which also helps to diversify the culture in the country. EG:- Economic advisor, Phillipe Legrain, estimates that 1,000 refugee businesses could generate \$100 million each year. Most studies conclude that refugees have very little effect on the job market at all. The U.S. State Department's analysis of the labor market over a 30-year period showed that not only did refugees not negatively impact the job market, but they had no effect when compared to regions with no refugee population. EL:- Thus by closing off borders, countries are also depriving themselves of opportunities where they can further enjoy and enhance economic growth. This in turn deprives citizens of the culture they can get to experience, jobs created through the creation of ground-up businesses by these refugees and more, thus even doing a disservice to the citizens. https://borgenproject.org/benefits-of-aiding-refugees/ https://www.oxfam.org/en/europes-borders-migrants-and-refugees-are-denied-their-basic-human-rights
TS 4	TS + EX:- The rise of regional and international organizations to foster

	international cooperation to resolve cross border problems such as environmental and territorial issues, render national boundaries to have little relevance. Many of the world issues plaguing us today are cross-borders such as terrorism, trade in weapons, haze etc. Examples of regional organizations include ASEAN to resolve cross border issues such as the South China Sea and even the Indonesia haze problem. These issues are brought up to the ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) where member countries can debate about them and see how best to resolve them. Also, the UN has been pretty proactive in trying to resolve cross border smuggling and trading of weapons, especially in tackling state sponsored terrorism. These issues have wide-scale impact that could not be resolved just by nations, rather it requires the involvement of many parties.
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ENVIRONMENT

Question	"The individual is powerless (ABSOLUTE TERM!!! → cannot write things like partially powerless) in the fight against climate change" Discuss.
Stand	The individual has a small degree of power in the fight against climate change, even if they have the potential to influence a systemic change together. "It is not true that the individual is utterly powerless to combat climate change. Indeed, the individual does have a modicum of power in the fight against climate change. Yet, the truth is that most of the power lies with organisations and governments, which means that the individual is much less able to bring about positive change."
TS 1	<i>At the same time, individuals do hold some power through personal choices, however, ultimately most of the power lies in the hands of huge corporations .</i> People may say individuals do have roles as consumers. But limitations to that: not all individuals have the same amount of power. Businesses have a final say on how these products are presented in the market Limitation of changes within the market-based solutions → Consumers are limited to just buying → e.g. green products too expensive for lower

	income ppl → up to businesses to satisfy decision; broad public do not get to determine how production is shaped
TS 2	The individual has indeed very little power in the fight against climate change as the root cause of climate change is deep-seated, making it a wicked problem. , Explanation:- can talk about the complexity about the climate change having many underlying issues → long standing history about carbon emissions from countries due to industrialisation (give examples) Example: In fact, The concept of a personal carbon footprint and calculating one's footprint was popularized by oil producer BP as "effective propaganda" as way to shift their responsibility to "linguistically... remove itself as a contributor to the problem of climate change → blame is shifted to individuals as a way for carbon emitting firms to escape responsibility which is too much of a burden for a single individual to bear If we are in blame, we cannot blame the leaders → then we think about recycle → little effectiveness → burden shifted on individual purposefully
TS 3	At the same time, the individual has some power against climate change as some individuals are part of a very affluent and influential community who has the potential to make a huge impact through their actions. - The problem could be the affluent people ⇒ from 1990 to 2015, the wealthiest 1% of the world emitted more than 50% of the bottom of humanity. Richest 10% is responsible for 50% of global emissions (incl SG) ~ individuals are v responsible -
TS 4	- However, reducing their emissions means requiring to rethink what prosperity means. Shifting our attitudes is not so simple→ Costly and difficult to work outside the cultural norms → Pursuing certain environmentally friendly behaviour may be looked down upon and u may also be considered as failure - Individuals do not act in vacuums. - Individuals cannot dematerialise their lives. Because of societal expectations Nevertheless, certain individuals have very little power in the fight against

	climate change as these individuals can be part of a marginalised community in society whose voices cannot reach the important bodies.
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CRIME AND PUNISHMENT

(Ignore this essay outline because the essay outline here is flawed)

Question	"Any punishment that does aim to rehabilitate the criminal is unjustified" To what extent do you agree?
Stand	I agree to it to a large extent, although in some cases it is justified to rehabilitate the criminal for a crime.
TS 1	IN THE CASE OF SEVERE CRIMES, I largely agree that the punishment which aims to rehabilitate the criminal is not justified because rehabilitating the criminal is a punishment disproportionate to the severity of the crime. TOO LENIENT A PUNISHMENT CONSIDERING THE IMPACTS TO SOCIETY AND THE MORAL WRONGNESS OF THE ACTION.
TS 2	However, in some cases, rehabilitation is justified as a punishment for the criminal's actions when the criminal's actions stems from influence from his environment or serious mental illness which takes some of the blame off the perpetrator's actions
TS 3	Nevertheless, I still largely agree that the aim to rehabilitate the criminal is not justified as a punishment as it takes a lot of resources and manpower to carry out rehabilitation programmes that are funded by taxpayer dollars. ADDITIONALLY, FOR THE MOST HARDENED OF CRIMINALS, ATTEMPTING A REHABILITATION-FOCUSSED APPROACH IS EXTREMELY FOOLISH, SINCE IT WOULD BE A WASTE OF STATE RESOURCES, NOT TO MENTION A FAILURE OF THE STATE TO ENSURE THAT LARGER SOCIETY IS PROTECTED FROM THESE DANGEROUS ELEMENTS (WHO SHOULD BE LOCKED UP FOREVER)
TS 4	I largely agree that rehabilitation is largely unjustified because it does not always guarantee that it would lead to positive consequences which may thus threaten the safety of society. ← I recommend you combine this with TS1